

Hidden environmental cost of AI-generated images. Think twice, do better.

Posted by u/vago8080 • 0 points • 36 comments

Hey everyone, I came across this eye-opening study about the energy consumption of AI image generation. It turns out, generating just nine images using AI is as energy-intensive as fully charging our smartphone.

This revelation comes from a study by Carnegie Mellon University and HuggingFace. They found that AI generative models, especially those for image creation like DALL-E, consume significantly more energy than text-based models like ChatGPT. On average, creating 1,000 inferences with these models can use between 0.06 to 2.9 kWh, with the mean being around 1.35 kWh. To put that in perspective, the average smartphone requires just 0.012 kWh to charge.

What's more alarming is the CO2 emissions associated with this. Each image can generate between 0.1 to 0.5 grams of CO2, and the more inefficient models can emit up to 2 grams per image.

It's crucial we consider these findings, especially when using AI for generating images for fun or karma farming. Each image comes with a cost to our planet. Let's be more mindful about how and why we use these technologies.

Thoughts?

Source: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2311.16863>

Comments

u/Longjumping-Lab-2137 • 0 points • 2024-06-05 05:28 UTC

Energy doesn't produce carbon... retards and their retardation man its annoying af...

Most data centers end up using nuclear or hydro electric... for fucks sake...

I am getting sick and tired of small brained squirrel fucking idiots spouting distorted statistics.

People need to be able to openly call them retarded ass mother fuckers.

u/vago8080 • 1 points • 2023-12-09 15:42 UTC

Hey OP! Fuck you! How dare you come here with scientific research and evidence. Take that to intelligent people that actually know how to read papers and care about something.

I use this tool to disguise my mediocrity in front of my family, friends, and my employer! How do you expect me to look intelligent? studying? GTFO

u/Embarrassed_Ear2390 • 1 points • 2023-12-09 17:09 UTC

I hope you get the help you need.

u/johnix23 • 2 points • 2023-12-09 15:39 UTC

Goods to finally have figures.

They're actually surprisingly low.

Less than a gram of CO2 per image, and 200g of beef release 12kg CO2.

So if you're worried about your footprint, cut down on your air travel, beef consumption and garments purchases, but go ahead and indulge in AI. Whatever else you were going to do with your time was probably going to have a higher footprint.

u/vago8080 • 1 points • 2023-12-09 15:48 UTC

> Less than a gram of CO2 per image, and 200g of beef release 12kg CO2.

In a cow's lifetime.

u/Lob-Star • 1 points • 2023-12-09 15:25 UTC

Imagine how much energy is wasted by actual artists consuming resources to live and create.

u/vago8080 • 1 points • 2023-12-09 15:29 UTC

I am ok with killing off a few thousand artists in order to compensate for IA image generation.

Is that you ChatGPT?

u/dgkimpton • 1 points • 2023-12-09 15:22 UTC

I mean, yes, undoubtedly. But so does computer gaming and I don't see people giving up their marathon WoW sessions any time soon, nor turning their heating down to a perfectly livably if uncomfortable 15C, nor taking down their Christmas lights, nor stopping their rampant consumerism of cheap junk, but sure... let's all call out AI images as the form of happiness people should give up.

u/vago8080 • 1 points • 2023-12-09 15:25 UTC

Everything adds up. Specially if you are not aware. I was just trying to bring some awareness backed by scientific research.

u/Zamael131 • 3 points • 2023-12-09 14:59 UTC

every single human task deliver co2 to environment.

Years ago, BP (british petroleum) one of the most big petroleum corporations in whole world, hire a public relationship company to "clear his image" in environmental matters, then this company create a whole advertaising campaing about "personal carbon foot print", making ppl responsable for environmental polition with his daily routines. (you can go to wiki to read about it)

this kind of things like, "bitcoin is so poluting" or "<insert_here_wherever_what_you_want> is so poluting" is about the same.

without a doubt, the only actors in this game capable to really stop puluting environment are the same that reciving earns from poluting. not people. just big corporations.

so. please stop to spread alarming and misinformation things. thx.